Name: _____ **Date:** _____

Go to Scope Online to listen to the words and definitions read aloud!

Vocabulary:

Once a Crook, Always a Crook?

1. **bittersweet (BIH-ter-sweet)** *adjective*; Something with a bittersweet flavor is both bitter and sweet at the same time. *Bittersweet* can also be used to describe a blend of happy and sad emotions. Winning second place could be a bittersweet experience if you are happy to have done well but still sad that you didn't come in first place.

2. **clemency (KLEM-uhn-see)** *noun*; Clemency is kindness or mercy shown by someone in charge to someone who has done something wrong and could be punished harshly. For example, if Bob breaks the law and the punishment for his crime is five years in prison, a judge could show clemency and sentence Bob to only six months in jail.

3. **lapel (luh-PEL)** *noun*; A lapel is the front part of a jacket or coat that is folded back.

4. **pardon (PAR-duhn)** *verb or noun*; If you pardon someone, you forgive or excuse them for something they did wrong. *Pardon* can also mean "to officially say that someone who is guilty of a crime will go free."

   As a noun, *pardon* is the act of pardoning, or excusing, someone. So you could say that the president has the power to pardon people, or you could say that the president has the power to give pardons.

5. **saunter (SAWN-ter)** *verb*; To saunter is to walk slowly and in a relaxed way.

6. **time lock (TAHYM lahk)** *noun*; A time lock is a kind of lock that is placed inside the door of a safe or vault and set so that it's impossible to open the door except at a certain time.

"Can People Change?"

7. **incredulous (in-KREJ-uh-luhs)** *adjective*; If you are incredulous, you are unwilling or unable to believe that something is true. If a friend says that he was kidnapped by aliens when he was a baby, you would probably give him an incredulous look.

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"The Legend of the Man-Eating Monster"

8. **sweat lodge (SWET loj)** *noun*; A sweat lodge is a small building that is made hot and steamy inside by pouring water over stones that have been heated in a fire. In North America, sweat lodges have traditionally been used mainly by Native Americans. The basic idea of a sweat lodge is that you sit inside for a few hours and sweat out all the bad stuff inside of you—stuff like sickness and pain and negative emotions—to become pure both physically and spiritually.

9. **tread (TRED)** *verb or noun*; *Tread* is a synonym for *walk*. *Tread* is sometimes used to mean "walk in a strong and heavy way," but it is also possible to tread lightly—that is, to walk in a careful way, as you would if you were making your way through a flower garden.

   Tread can be used as a noun too. It can refer to the part of a tire or a shoe that touches the ground, or to a mark left on the ground after a tire rolls over it.

10. **wigwam (WIG-wawm)** *noun*; In the past, members of some Native American tribes lived in wigwams: dome-shaped shelters made of wooden frames covered with tree bark or animal skins.

Directions: In the space below and on the back of this page (if necessary), list any other words from the play, fable, or folktale whose definitions you are not sure about. For each word, use context clues to try to figure out the meaning. Then look up the word in a few different dictionaries. Discuss the meaning of the word with your teacher or another adult. Then write a definition for the word and one example sentence.

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Vocabulary Practice

Once a Crook, Always a Crook?, "Can People Change?," and "The Legend of the Man-Eating Monster"

Directions: In each sentence, underline the word in bold that makes the most sense.

1. After two years in prison, Ms. Parker was granted **time lock/clemency** and released.

2. William wore a small American flag pin on his **tread/lapel**.

3. The governor announced that he would **pardon/clemency** the people who were fined for being too loud at the backyard birthday party. "Those folks just need to learn to control their excitement," he said.

4. At night, the jewelry store keeps most of its merchandise in a safe with a **lapel/time lock**.

5. At the museum, Ashley learned about the **sweat lodges/wigwams** once lived in by members of the Shawnee tribe.

6. To save time, we decided to **tread/saunter** through the field instead of taking the long way on the road.

Directions: Follow the directions below to describe the meaning of the words in bold.

7. Describe a situation in which you would be **incredulous**.

8. If you were running late to catch a bus, would you **saunter** to the bus stop? Explain.

9. Describe a **bittersweet** experience that you had.

10. A robber has sneakily learned the combination to open the vault at the Richmond National Bank. Now all he has to do is open it when no one is looking, grab as much money as he can, and run to a getaway car. However, the vault has a **time lock** on it. How could the **time lock** ruin the robber's plan?

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